FM 506-E/2 · FIELD MANUAL · RESTRICTED 17 SEPTEMBER 1944 – 25 FEBRUARY 1945

EASY COMPANY

EUROPEAN WAR ROUTE

WWII • 1944 - 1945



EASY COMPANY IN

HOLLAND & BASTOGNE

Company E · 506th Parachute Infantry · 101st Airborne Division

48 SITES · 5 DAYS · 21 POSITIONS

Free guide · dzcharlie.com · Printed edition of the phone guide. Positions carry a rating for how sure we are of the exact spot: HIGH (exact spot known), MEDIUM (right area), LOW (general area only).

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THE STORY IN BRIEF

This guide follows Company E, 506th Parachute Infantry, from the jump into Holland on 17 September 1944 to its last combat at Haguenau in February 1945 — the campaigns of Market Garden, the Island, Bastogne and Alsace. Two sets of positions are kept apart on purpose:

TIMELINE — 21 historical positions in date order: what happened, where and when. **TOUR** — 38 stops in driving order across five days: where to go, for how long, and where to sleep. Every stop opens directly in Google Maps.

Holland — 17 September 1944. Market Garden was the opposite of Normandy: a daylight jump, on target, the company together within the hour. The 506th's bridge at Son was blown as they reached it; they crossed on a footbridge that night and walked into Eindhoven the next day to a liberation party. On 19–20 September Easy rode British tanks toward Helmond and ran into the 107th Panzer Brigade at Nuenen and was thrown back — about fifteen casualties by the company's own accounts, Randleman hiding in a barn. (Easy moved out on the 19th; many Dutch and battlefield accounts date the main fighting at Nuenen to the 20th.) For a week the company ran up and down Hell's Highway as the Germans cut it at Veghel and Koevering, while at Arnhem the British were being destroyed.

The Island. When Arnhem was lost the 101st took over the polder between the Waal and the Neder-Rijn. On 5 October Winters led about 35 men against a much larger SS force (often put at two companies, mainly on Winters' own estimate) at a dike crossroads near Heteren and drove it back — his last fight as company commander. Easy covered the night crossing of Operation Pegasus that rescued about 138 Allied evaders, mostly British, lost its new commander Heyliger to a nervous sentry, and spent seven weeks in the wet under shellfire. It jumped into Holland with 154 men and left with 98.

Bastogne — December 1944. From the barracks at Mourmelon the 101st was thrown into the Ardennes on 18 December with grossly inadequate winter clothing and not enough ammunition. Easy dug in on the edge of the Bois Jacques looking down on Foy and was cut off there for about six days in bitter cold. The 4th Armored Division of Patton's Third Army broke through on the 26th; the shelling of 3 January took Toye's and Guarnere's legs; a barrage on 10 January killed Muck and Penkala.

Foy, Noville, Rachamps — January 1945. On 13 January Easy attacked across the open snow into Foy; when Dike's advance stalled — described by Winters, Lipton and most other witnesses as freezing; Clancy Lyall later gave a different recollection, that Dike had been hit in the shoulder — Winters sent Speirs, who ran through the village and back. Noville fell on the 15th and Rachamps on the 16th — the night the schoolgirls sang in the church. The 101st was relieved on 17 January. Bastogne cost the company fourteen dead — the names on the Bois Jacques memorial — with about 32 wounded and 21 more evacuated with frostbite or trench foot.

Haguenau — February 1945. Moved to Alsace in late January, as Operation Nordwind (begun 1 January) was ending, Easy fought its last combat here, holding one bank of the narrow Moder inside Haguenau with the Germans on the other. A patrol on the night of 15 February crossed the river and brought back two prisoners; Jackson was mortally wounded when his own grenade went off during the raid — accounts differ on whether enemy fire caused it. Winters cancelled the second patrol. On 25 February the company left the line for the last time.

What came next. Presidential Unit Citation at Mourmelon on 15 March; then the Rhine, Bavaria, the camps at Landsberg and the Eagle's Nest — the Germany & Austria app picks up the story.

THE ACCURACY RULE

Memorials, museums, bridges and villages are exact. Foxholes and the dike crossroads are documented and marked. But a company's billets in Haguenau, a patrol route on the Island or the exact spot a sentry fired are not — those positions are marked Area or Medium, and the pin is the centre of a search area, not a foxhole.

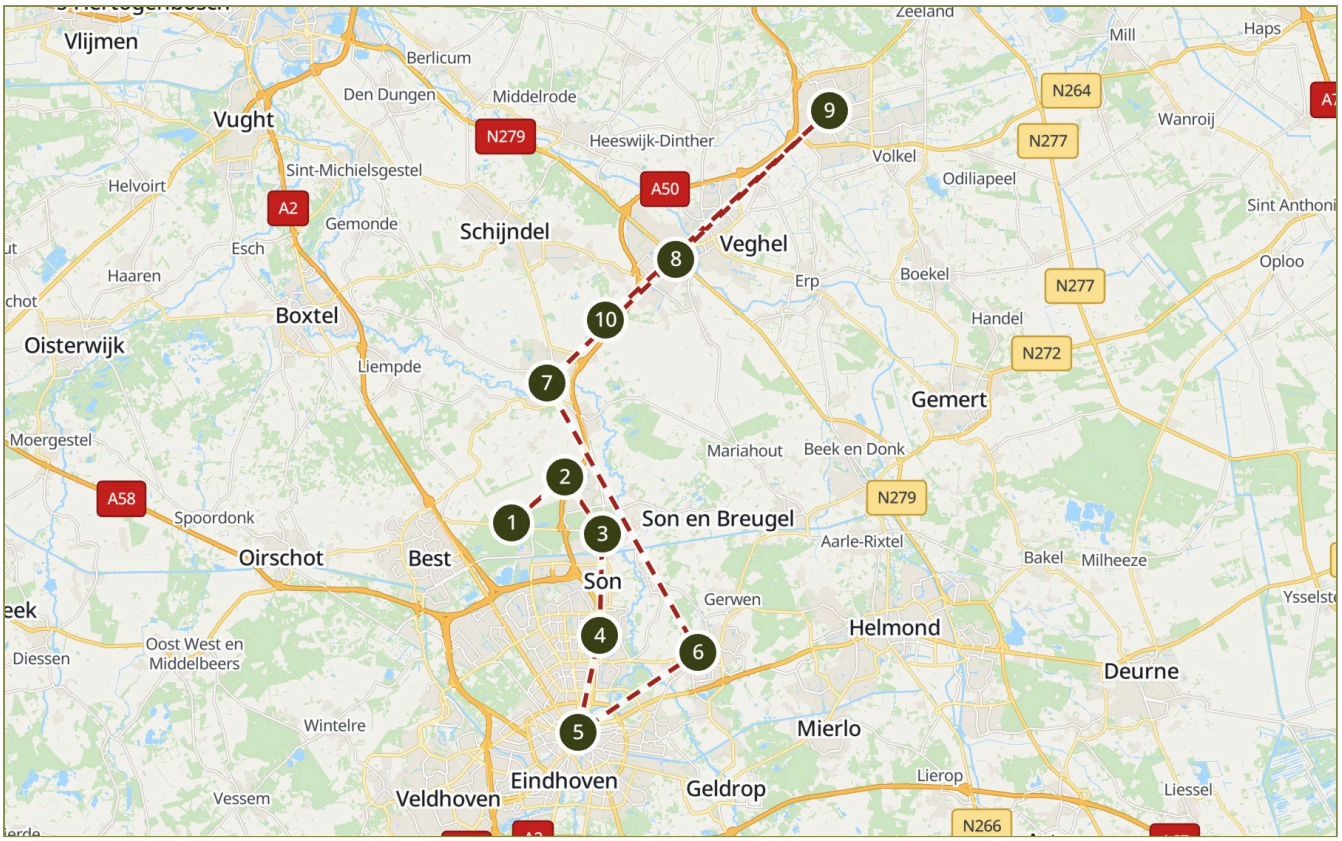
HIGH exact spot known — a landmark, museum, memorial or town MEDIUM well supported, but the exact spot is uncertain LOW general area only — the pin is the centre of a search area

HIGH exact spot known — a landmark, museum, memorial or town MEDIUM well supported, but the exact spot is uncertain LOW general area only — the pin is the centre of a search area

WHY THE WIDER TOUR

The full route adds the bridges the plan turned on — Grave, Nijmegen, Arnhem — the Bulge's northern shoulder at La Gleize and Malmedy, and the headquarters cellar where "Nuts!" was written, so that Easy's foxholes make sense inside a battle of half a million men.

DAY 1 — HELL'S HIGHWAY — SON TO UDEN



1 Wings of Liberation Museum, Best
2 Drop Zone B — Sonse Heide
3 Son bridge & 101st Airborne memorial
4 Airborne Memorial, Eindhoven (Woensel)
5 Eindhoven — 18 Septemberplein
6 Nuenen — 101st Airborne memorial
7 Sint-Oedenrode
8 Veghel — canal bridges
9 Uden
10 Koevering

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Best → Son → Eindhoven → Nuenen → Sint-Oedenrode → Veghel → Uden · 10 stops

The daylight jump, the blown bridge, the liberation of Eindhoven, the Nuenen ambush and the single road the whole operation depended on. Everything is within 30 km.

1 Wings of Liberation Museum, Best

HIGH Museum · beside the 101st landing zone · ≈105 min

Vehicles, aircraft, a Waco glider and the story of the Brabant liberation, on the edge of the ground the 101st landed on. The right start: it explains the plan before you drive the road.

What you can see: Look at the map of the corridor first; the museum sits almost on Drop Zone B.

Plan: Sonseweg 39, Best · check bevrijdendevleugels.com for hours.

GPS 51.51595, 5.44020

2 Drop Zone B — Sonse Heide

HIGH Timeline 1 · ≈20 min

The heath where the 506th came down on 17 September in near-perfect order. Nothing marks the exact spot; the flat open ground is the point.

What you can see: Compare with Normandy: daylight, no flooding, the company together in an hour.

GPS 51.53200, 5.47000

3 Son bridge & 101st Airborne memorial

HIGH Memorial · Timeline 2 · ≈30 min · ★ must see

The Wilhelmina Canal crossing the Germans blew as the 506th arrived; the memorial stands on 17 Septemberplein beside the modern bridge. Engineers bridged the gap overnight; Easy crossed on the footbridge.

What you can see: Stand at the water's edge: the far bank is where the 88 was.

GPS 51.51200, 5.49120

4 Airborne Memorial, Eindhoven (Woensel)

HIGH Memorial · Timeline 3 · ≈20 min

On Airbornelaan, the road the 506th used to enter the city on 18 September. Placed by 101st veterans in 1969.

What you can see: Read the plaque: the link-up with the British Second Army happened a few streets from here.

GPS 51.47640, 5.48970

5 Eindhoven — 18 Septemberplein

HIGH Town · ≈45 min

The square named for liberation day. Easy marched through cheering crowds here; that night the Luftwaffe bombed the city and the celebrations ended.

What you can see: Walk the centre; the Philips town the paratroopers saw was largely rebuilt.

GPS 51.44250, 5.47750

6 Nuenen — 101st Airborne memorial

HIGH Memorial · Timeline 4 · ≈30 min · ★ must see

Beside the village liberation monument, a plaque naming nine Easy Company men who fell in Holland between 19 September and 5 October. The ambush of 19–20 September happened on the road east of here.

What you can see: Look east along the road toward Helmond: open fields, no cover — tank country.

GPS 51.47058, 5.54512

7 Sint-Oedenrode

HIGH Town · Hell's Highway · ≈20 min

The 502nd's town on the corridor; the highway through it is the original road. A good place to feel how narrow the whole operation was.

What you can see: One road, two ditches, flat fields either side.

GPS 51.56480, 5.45990

8 Veghel — canal bridges

MEDIUM Town · Timeline 6 · ≈30 min

Four bridges over the canal and the river made Veghel the corridor's most vulnerable point; the Germans attacked it on 22 September and the 101st fought for two days to keep the road open.

What you can see: The bridges over the Zuid-Willemsvaart are the objective everyone wanted.

GPS 51.60815, 5.53253

9 Uden

HIGH Town · Timeline 5 · ≈20 min

Where Winters and a handful of Easy men were cut off on 22 September, bluffing a defence of the town until the road was reopened.

What you can see: The market square; the corridor road runs through it.

GPS 51.66000, 5.61900

Read more: Wikipedia: Operation Market Garden

10 Koevering

MEDIUM Hamlet · Timeline 6 · ≈15 min

The last cut of Hell's Highway, 24–25 September, on the straight road between Sint-Oedenrode and Veghel. Burnt-out convoys lined the road here while Arnhem fell.

What you can see: Drive it slowly; the road is the exhibit.

GPS 51.58694, 5.49290

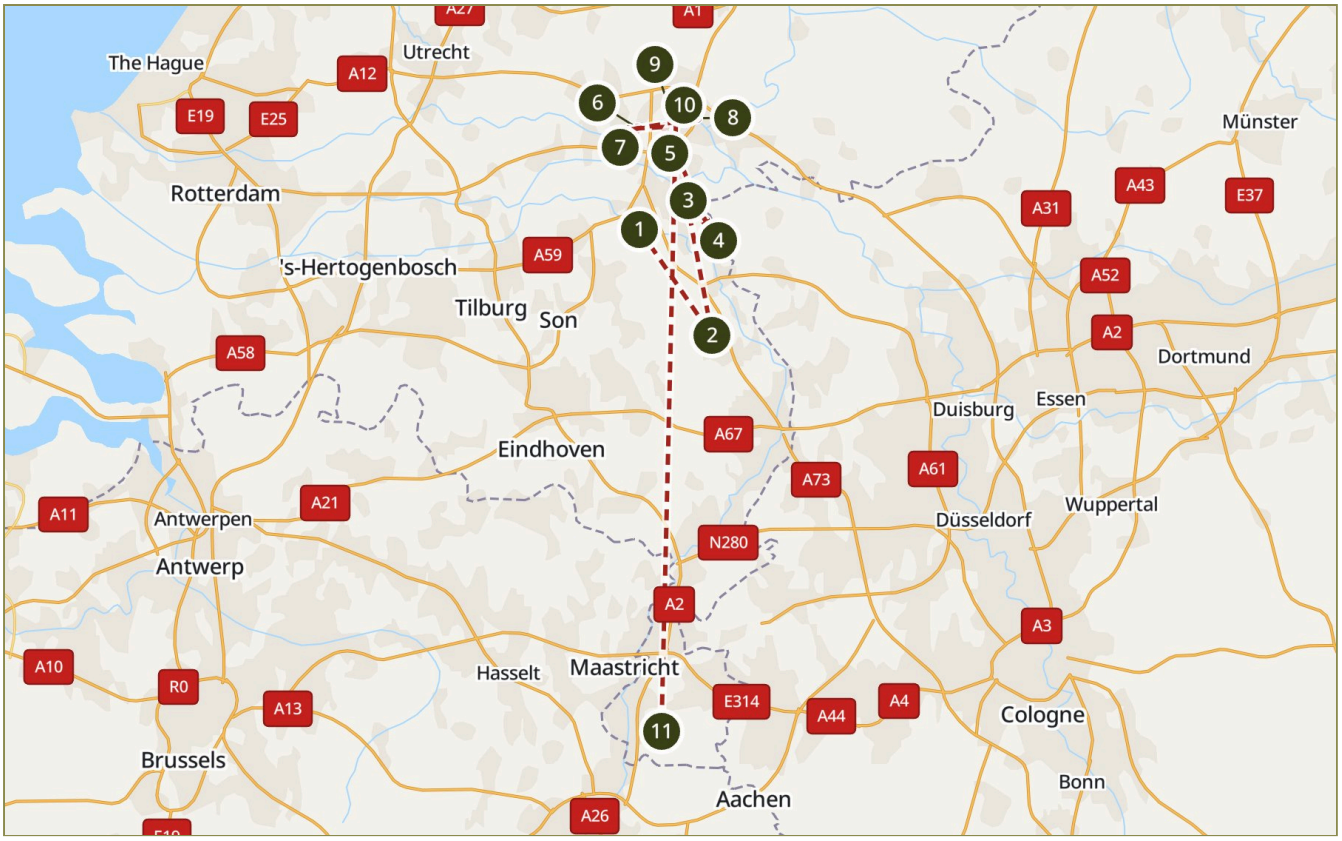
Read more: Wikipedia: Operation Market Garden

End of day 1 — overnight: Son / Eindhoven

Camperplaats Son en Breugel (or an Eindhoven city aire) · Son en Breugel, Noord-Brabant

Small municipal motorhome places exist in Son, Best and Eindhoven — check park4night or campercontact for the current one and its services · GPS 51.51200, 5.49200

DAY 2 — THE ISLAND AND ARNHEM



1 Grave bridge (John S. Thompson bridge)
2 Overloon War Museum
3 Nijmegen — Waal crossing & road bridge
4 Freedom Museum, Groesbeek
5 Driel — Polish brigade memorial
6 Crossroads memorial, Heteren
7 Operation Pegasus — river bank sector
8 John Frost Bridge, Arnhem
9 Airborne Museum Hartenstein, Oosterbeek
10 Airborne War Cemetery, Oosterbeek
11 Netherlands American Cemetery, Margraten

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Grave → Nijmegen → Groesbeek → Driel → Heteren crossroads → Arnhem → Oosterbeek · 9 stops

North along the corridor to the bridges, then onto the Island for Easy's crossroads fight and the Rhine crossing, ending where Market Garden ended — Arnhem.

1 Grave bridge (John S. Thompson bridge)

HIGH Bridge · 82nd Airborne · ≈20 min

The Maas bridge taken intact by the 504th within minutes of landing on 17 September — the first Market Garden bridge secured.

What you can see: The 82nd's textbook success, in contrast to Son.

GPS 51.76925, 5.73665

2 Overloon War Museum

HIGH D-Day · Market Garden aftermath · ≈60 min

Site of the October 1944 tank battle east of the corridor; one of the largest vehicle collections in Europe.

What you can see: Two hours; big halls.

GPS 51.56996, 5.95694

3 Nijmegen — Waal crossing & road bridge

HIGH Bridge · 82nd Airborne · ≈30 min

On 20 September the 504th crossed the Waal in canvas boats under fire while the Guards' tanks rushed the road bridge. Half the boats were lost; the bridge fell at 19:00. The Waal crossing memorial stands on the south bank.

What you can see: The width of the river is the story.

GPS 51.85110, 5.87170

4 Freedom Museum, Groesbeek

HIGH Museum · ≈90 min

The whole Market Garden and Rhineland story, on the 82nd's landing ground above Nijmegen.

What you can see: Use the corridor map to place Easy's road inside the plan.

Plan: Check vrijheidsmuseum.nl for hours.

GPS 51.78565, 5.93701

5 Driel — Polish brigade memorial

HIGH Memorial · ≈20 min

Where Sosabowski's Poles landed on 21 September and tried to reach the trapped British across the river. The Island begins here.

What you can see: Look north across the Rhine to Oosterbeek.

GPS 51.96117, 5.81389

6 Crossroads memorial, Heteren

HIGH Memorial · Timeline 8 · ≈45 min · ★ must see

On the Randwijkse Rijndijk, the junction where Winters' attack of 5 October broke a larger SS force. The memorial names Pvt. William Dukeman, Easy's one man killed.

What you can see: Climb the dike, look toward the river, then back at the junction — the whole action fits in the view.

GPS 51.95861, 5.73173

7 Operation Pegasus — river bank sector

MEDIUM Timeline 9 · ≈20 min

The stretch of the Neder-Rijn where about 138 Allied evaders, mostly British, were rowed across on the night of 22–23 October with Easy on the bank.

What you can see: The far bank is Renkum; the woods there hid the escapers.

GPS 51.95573, 5.70521

8 John Frost Bridge, Arnhem

HIGH Bridge · British 1st Airborne · ≈30 min

A bridge too far: Frost's 700 men held the north end for four days and were overrun on 21 September. The rebuilt bridge carries his name.

What you can see: Stand at the north end; the houses the paras held were on this side.

GPS 51.97750, 5.91150

9 Airborne Museum Hartenstein, Oosterbeek

HIGH Museum · ≈90 min

Urquhart's headquarters hotel, now the museum of the Arnhem battle: nine days in the perimeter, then Operation Berlin's night evacuation.

What you can see: The evacuation route ran south from here to the river — the same river Easy watched from the other side a month later.

Plan: Check airbornemuseum.nl for hours.

GPS 51.98775, 5.83267

10 Airborne War Cemetery, Oosterbeek

HIGH Cemetery · ≈30 min

1,700 graves, mostly of the 1st Airborne Division. Local schoolchildren lay flowers here every September.

What you can see: End the day here.

GPS 51.99360, 5.84842

11 Netherlands American Cemetery, Margraten

HIGH D-Day · Cemetery · 8,300 graves · ≈40 min

American dead of Holland, the Bulge and the Rhineland, including 101st men.

What you can see: Between the Dutch and Belgian legs of the tour.

GPS 50.81775, 5.80338

End of day 2 — overnight: Oosterbeek / Arnhem

Camping/aire in the Arnhem–Oosterbeek area · Oosterbeek, Gelderland

Several campsites on the Veluwe edge north of Oosterbeek; check park4night for a motorhome place with services · GPS 51.99000, 5.84000

DAY 3 — BASTOGNE — THE BOIS JACQUES



1 Bastogne War Museum & Mardasson Memorial
2 Bizory
3 Easy Company memorial, Bois Jacques
4 Easy Company foxholes, Bois Jacques
5 Foy
6 Noville
7 Rachamps — church & Easy Company memorial
8 Recogne German war cemetery

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Mardasson → Bizory → Easy memorial → foxholes → Foy → Noville → Rachamps → Recogne · 8 stops

The company's hardest month on the ground it was fought over: the wood, the foxholes, the open snowfield to Foy, and the villages beyond. A long drive from Arnhem (about 2.5 h) — start early or sleep in Bastogne the night before.

1 Bastogne War Museum & Mardasson Memorial

HIGH Museum · memorial · ≈120 min · ★ must see

The best single museum of the Bulge, beside the star-shaped American memorial. Do it first: it gives the siege its shape before you go into the woods.

What you can see: Walk up to the Mardasson after the museum and look north-east — the Bois Jacques is the dark line on the skyline.

Plan: Check bastognewarmuseum.be for hours.

GPS 50.00850, 5.73850

2 Bizory

HIGH Hamlet · ≈15 min

The 506th's right-hand village; the road from here to Foy runs straight through the Easy Company positions.

What you can see: Turn north onto the Foy road.

GPS 50.01957, 5.76432

3 Easy Company memorial, Bois Jacques

HIGH Memorial · Timeline 14–15 · ≈30 min · ★ must see

Built by the Men of Easy Company Foundation on the Bizory–Foy road: fourteen names of Easy men killed here between 18 December and 13 January, and a text about −28 °C nights with little food and ammunition.

What you can see: Read the names, then walk on into the wood.

GPS 50.02890, 5.75671

4 Easy Company foxholes, Bois Jacques

HIGH Battlefield · Timeline 14 · ≈45 min · ★ must see

The preserved foxholes on both sides of the road, looking down on Foy. Shallower now, but unmistakable; numbered markers and an app-guided walk since 2022 (paid entry).

What you can see: Stand in a hole facing Foy. The tree line behind you is where the tree bursts came from.

Plan: Paid entry since 2022; QR-code audio guide at the entrance.

GPS 50.03353, 5.76039

5 Foy

HIGH Village · Timeline 17 · ≈30 min · ★ must see

The village Easy attacked across the open snow on 13 January, and where Speirs made his run. The 101st memorial stands in the village.

What you can see: From the church look back up the slope to the wood-line: 250 m of nothing.

GPS 50.04469, 5.74920

Read more: Wikipedia: Foy, Belgium · Wikipedia: Siege of Bastogne

6 Noville

HIGH Village · Timeline 18 · ≈30 min

Team Desobry's stand on 19–20 December, then the 506th's objective on 14–15 January. A small museum and memorials in the village.

What you can see: The crossroads and church are the landmarks.

GPS 50.06150, 5.75730

Read more: Wikipedia: Siege of Bastogne

7 Rachamps — church & Easy Company memorial

HIGH Memorial · Timeline 19 · ≈30 min · ★ must see

Easy's last objective in the Ardennes, 16 January. The company slept in the church; the schoolgirls' choir sang. Memorial beside the church, tree planted by Guarnere and Heffron.

What you can see: End the Easy Company part of the day here.

GPS 50.08378, 5.78714

8 Recogne German war cemetery

HIGH Cemetery · ≈30 min

6,800 German dead from the Bulge, a kilometre from Foy — the men on the other side of the snowfield.

What you can see: Place of remembrance.

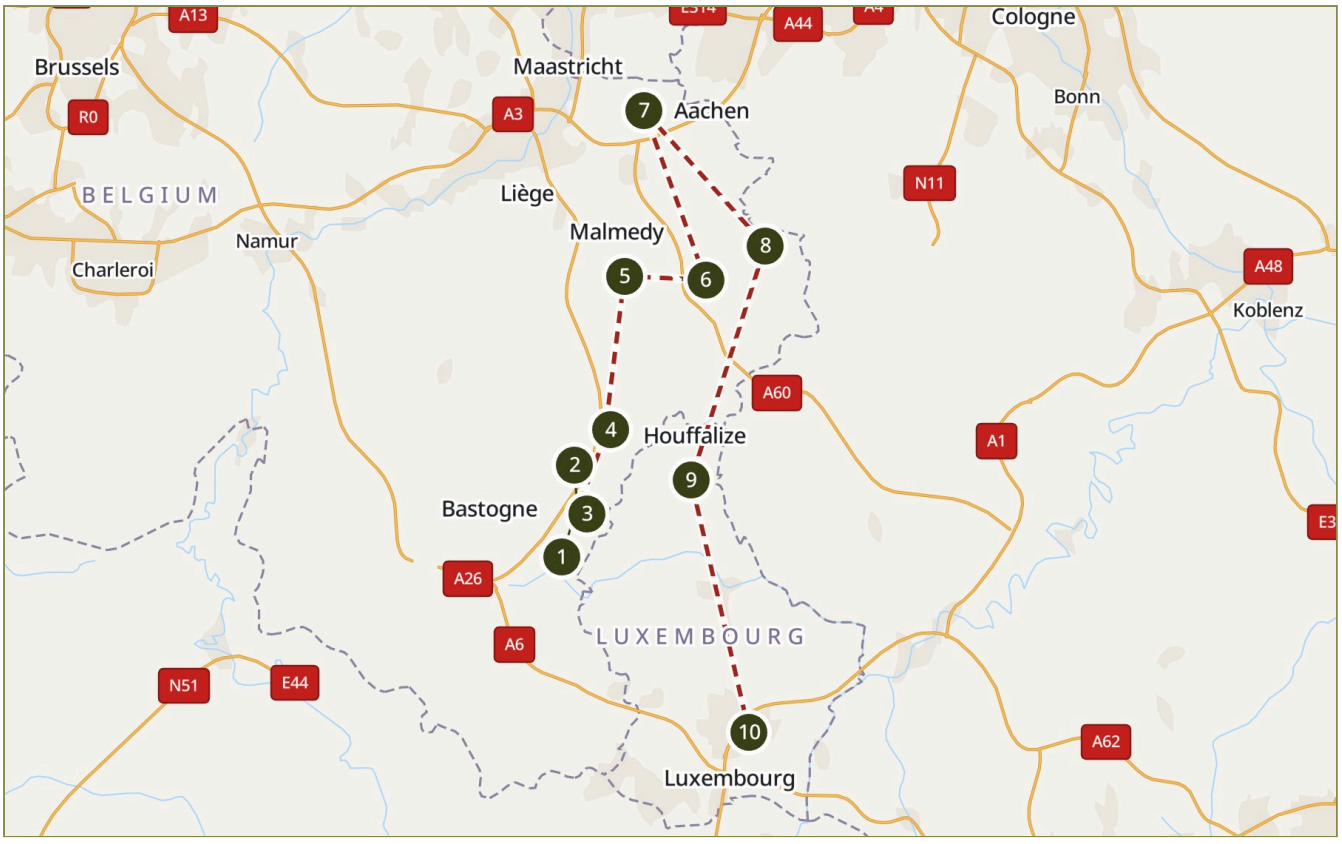
GPS 50.04842, 5.74087

End of day 3 — overnight: Bastogne

Camping de Renval, Bastogne · Route de Marche 148, 6600 Bastogne

Campsite with motorhome pitches on the west edge of town; verify season and services · GPS 50.00282, 5.69541

DAY 4 — BASTOGNE TOWN AND THE BULGE



1 101st Airborne Museum — Le Mess
2 Bastogne Barracks
3 Place McAuliffe & the Sherman
4 Houffalize — the Panther
5 December 44 Museum, La Gleize
6 Baugnez crossroads — Malmedy massacre memorial
7 Henri-Chapelle American Cemetery
8 Elsenborn Ridge
9 Clervaux — castle & museum
10 Luxembourg American Cemetery — Patton's grave

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Le Mess → Bastogne Barracks → McAuliffe square → Houffalize → La Gleize → Baugnez · 6 stops

Step outside the company: the headquarters that said 'Nuts', the town under siege, and the northern shoulder where the offensive was stopped. Long drive back to Bastogne or on toward Alsace.

1 101st Airborne Museum — Le Mess

HIGH Museum · ≈75 min

In the former officers' mess: uniforms, a bomb-shelter experience and a strong 101st collection. Avenue de la Gare 11.

What you can see: Good for the human scale of the siege.

Plan: Check 101airbornemuseumbastogne.com.

GPS 49.99925, 5.71221

2 Bastogne Barracks

HIGH Museum · McAuliffe's HQ · ≈90 min

The Belgian barracks where General McAuliffe's staff worked in the cellars and where the German surrender demand was answered with 'Nuts!' on 22 December. Guided visits; large vehicle restoration hall.

What you can see: The cellar is the real thing.

Plan: Guided tours only; check times.

GPS 50.01058, 5.71614

3 Place McAuliffe & the Sherman

HIGH Town square · ≈20 min

The square at the centre of the seven roads, with the general's bust and a Sherman tank knocked out at Renuamont.

What you can see: Count the roads: this is why 101st was sent here.

GPS 50.00070, 5.71700

4 Houffalize — the Panther

HIGH Town · ≈30 min

Where the US 1st and 3rd Armies met on 16 January to close the Bulge; a German Panther tank sits in the town centre.

What you can see: Same day Easy took Rachamps, 10 km south.

GPS 50.12894, 5.79070

5 December 44 Museum, La Gleize

HIGH Museum · ≈75 min

The high-water mark of Kampfgruppe Peiper on the northern shoulder, with a King Tiger outside.

What you can see: The German side of the offensive.

Plan: Check december44.com.

GPS 50.41006, 5.84559

6 Baugnez crossroads — Malmedy massacre memorial

HIGH Memorial · ≈30 min

The crossroads where 84 American prisoners were shot on 17 December. The Baugnez 44 Historical Center beside it closed permanently in January 2023; the memorial wall and the field remain open.

What you can see: Place of remembrance first.

Plan: Memorial only — the museum is closed.

GPS 50.40369, 6.06674

7 Henri-Chapelle American Cemetery

HIGH D-Day · Cemetery · 7,900 graves · ≈40 min

Bulge and Rhineland dead, north of Liège.

What you can see: On the way to the northern shoulder.

GPS 50.69661, 5.89908

8 Elsenborn Ridge

HIGH D-Day · The Bulge · northern shoulder · ≈60 min

Where the 2nd and 99th Divisions stopped the 6th Panzer Army — the shoulder that held.

What you can see: Open ridge; memorials at Rocherath-Krinkelt.

GPS 50.46300, 6.23000

9 Clervaux — castle & museum

HIGH D-Day · The Bulge · Luxembourg · ≈60 min

The castle held for two days by the 110th Infantry on 16–18 December, delaying Panzer Lehr on the road to Bastogne.

What you can see: Museum in the castle.

GPS 50.05450, 6.02700

10 Luxembourg American Cemetery — Patton's grave

HIGH D-Day · Cemetery · 5,000 graves · ≈40 min

The Third Army's dead of the Bulge and their general.

What you can see: Hamm, outside Luxembourg city.

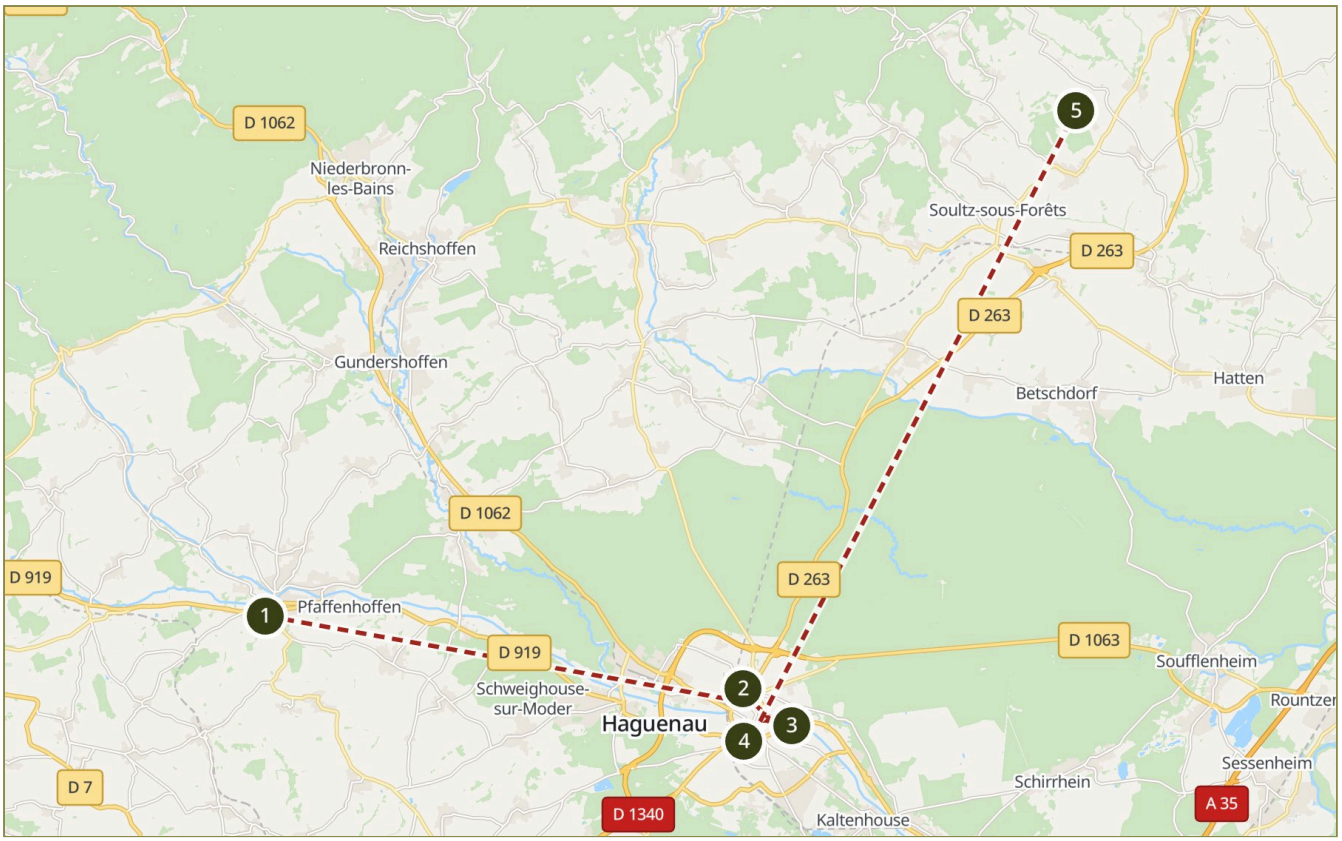
GPS 49.61150, 6.18550

End of day 4 — overnight: Bastogne (or drive to Alsace, ~3.5 h)

Camping de Renval, Bastogne · Route de Marche 148, 6600 Bastogne

Or push on to Haguenau in the evening to give Day 5 a full morning · GPS 50.00282, 5.69541

DAY 5 — ALSACE — HAGUENAU AND THE MODER



1 Moder valley sector — Pfaffenhoffen
2 Haguenau — the Moder river front
3 Liberation memorial — Moder canal
4 Haguenau centre & Musée Historique
5 Fort de Schoenenbourg — Maginot Line
6 Natzweiler-Struthof — off this map

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Pfaffenhoffen → Haguenau Moder front → Liberation memorial → town → Fort Schoenenbourg · 5 stops

The last combat: a narrow river, a town half-held, one patrol across the water. Finish on the Maginot Line to see the older fortress war the winter of 1945 was fought across.

1 Moder valley sector — Pfaffenhoffen

MEDIUM Timeline 20 · ≈15 min

The villages along the Moder west of Haguenau where the 506th held the line in late January, as Nordwind was ending, in deep snow.

What you can see: Drive the river road east toward Haguenau.

GPS 48.84200, 7.60600

2 Haguenau — the Moder river front

MEDIUM Timeline 21 · ≈30 min · ★ must see

Easy's side of the river inside the town. The houses along the south bank were the billets and observation posts; the Germans held the north bank a stone's throw away. The 15 February patrol crossed here somewhere.

What you can see: Walk the south bank. The river is the width of a street.

GPS 48.82000, 7.79200

3 Liberation memorial — Moder canal

HIGH Memorial · ≈15 min

On Boulevard de la Libération, marking where American tanks crossed the Moder canal on 16 March 1945 for the town's final liberation — three weeks after Easy left.

What you can see: The bronze reliefs show the crossing.

GPS 48.81626, 7.79761

4 Haguenau centre & Musée Historique

HIGH Town · museum · ≈60 min

The old Alsatian town Easy knew as a half-ruined front line; the history museum covers the two liberations of 1944–45.

What you can see: Compare the intact streets today with the shelled town of February 1945.

Plan: Check museum hours locally.

GPS 48.81289, 7.79188

5 Fort de Schoenenbourg — Maginot Line

HIGH Fortress · ≈120 min

The largest visitable Maginot fort in Alsace, 20 km north: kilometres of galleries and turrets. Context for the fortified border the 1945 winter fighting sat on.

What you can see: Bring a jacket — 12 °C underground.

Plan: Guided/self-guided; check lignemaginot.com.

GPS 48.96800, 7.91400

6 Natzweiler-Struthof

HIGH D-Day · Alsace · concentration camp · ≈60 min

The only Nazi camp on French soil; liberated November 1944.

What you can see: Memorial site in the Vosges.

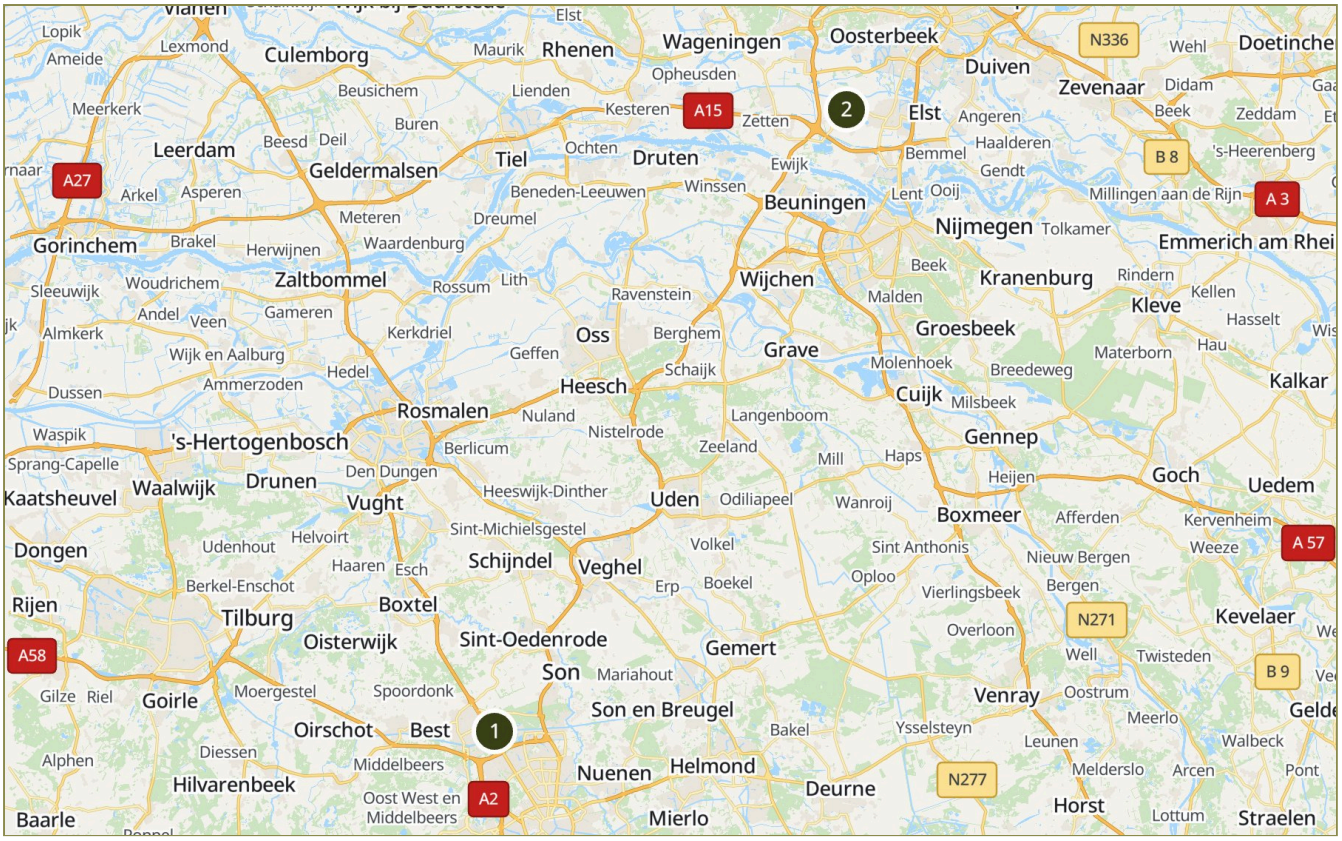
GPS 48.45480, 7.25250

End of day 5 — overnight: Haguenau / Strasbourg

Aire de camping-cars, Haguenau or Strasbourg · Haguenau, Bas-Rhin

Municipal aires in the Haguenau area; Strasbourg (30 min) has more choice — check park4night · GPS 48.81500, 7.78900

WORTH A DETOUR



1 Joe Mann memorial, Best 2 506th PIR memorial, Elst 3 Mourmelon-le-Grand — off this map

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

Extra sites on the Easy Company story, added to the tour when you have more days.

1 Joe Mann memorial, Best

HIGH Extra · 502nd PIR · ≈20 min

Pvt. Joe Mann of the 502nd threw himself on a grenade at the Best bridge fight on 19 September; Medal of Honor. The pelican memorial stands in the woods where the 502nd fought.

What you can see: Ten minutes from the Wings of Liberation museum.

GPS 51.50277, 5.41921

2 506th PIR memorial, Elst

HIGH Extra · the Island · ≈15 min

Memorial to the 506th on the Island, in the town the regiment held in October–November 1944.

What you can see: On the way from Driel to the Heteren crossroads.

GPS 51.92095, 5.80114

3 Mourmelon-le-Grand

HIGH Extra · Timeline 12 · far detour · ≈30 min

The Champagne garrison town where the 101st refitted between Holland and Bastogne, and where Easy returned after Haguenau. Still a French army camp.

What you can see: Only if you are driving Bastogne → Paris; two hours west of Bastogne.

GPS 49.14083, 4.36444

THE TIMELINE



1 Drop Zone B — Sonse Heide, north of Son
2 Son bridge — Wilhelmina Canal
3 Eindhoven — Woensel and the city centre
4 Nuenen — the ambush of 19–20 September
5 Uden — cut off on Hell's Highway
6 Veghel and Koevering — the road cuts
7 The Island — Zetten / Randwijk sector
8 The Crossroads — Randwijkse Rijndijk, Heteren
9 Operation Pegasus — the Rhine crossing
10 The dike — Heyliger shot by a sentry
11 The Island line — patrols, shelling, flood
12 Mourmelon-le-Grand — refit in Champagne
13 Bastogne — arrival by truck
14 Bois Jacques — the front line facing Foy
15 Bois Jacques — the shelling of 3 January
16 Bois Jacques — 9–10 January
17 Foy — the attack of 13 January
18 Noville
19 Rachamps — the last Bastogne attack
20 Alsace — the Moder line
21 Haguenau — the Moder river patrol

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

21 historical positions in date order: what happened, where and when. The numbers follow the company's movement.

1 Drop Zone B — Sonse Heide, north of Son

HIGH 17 Sep 1944 ~13:00 · Market Garden

Operation Market Garden opened in daylight. The 506th jumped onto the heath between Son and Best in the best drop the regiment ever had: on target, little flak, the company assembled within the hour. Compared with Normandy it was a parade.

On the ground: The Wings of Liberation museum stands beside the old landing ground. Look at the flat, open heath and imagine 6,700 men of the 101st coming down in one lift.

GPS 51.53200, 5.47000

2 Son bridge — Wilhelmina Canal

HIGH 17 Sep afternoon · Market Garden

The 506th's first objective. As the lead battalion reached the canal, the Germans blew the bridge; an 88 mm gun on the far bank fired down the road. Engineers rigged a footbridge that night and Easy crossed in the dark. The delay cost the whole corridor a day.

On the ground: Stand on the modern bridge and look at the canal's width: the whole timetable of Market Garden turned on this gap.

GPS 51.50561, 5.49207

3 Eindhoven — Woensel and the city centre

LOW 18 Sep 1944 · Market Garden

The 506th entered Eindhoven from the north through Woensel and cleared the town by early afternoon; Easy moved through the celebrations. The Guards Armoured Division's tanks arrived that evening and the corridor was open — a day late.

On the ground: The Airborne Memorial on Airbornelaan marks the entry route; the centre is where the crowds were.

GPS 51.47650, 5.48970

4 Nuenen — the ambush of 19–20 September

HIGH 19–20 Sep 1944 · Market Garden

Easy rode east on British Cromwell tanks toward Helmond and ran into the 107th Panzer Brigade at the edge of Nuenen. Tanks were knocked out, the company was pinned and pulled back with about fifteen casualties; Bull Randleman, missing, spent the night hiding in a barn. The memorial names nine Easy men who died in Holland.

On the ground: The village where Van Gogh painted the Potato Eaters. Read the open fields east of the memorial — this was tank country, not hedgerows.

GPS 51.47060, 5.54510

5 Uden — cut off on Hell's Highway

MEDIUM 20–22 Sep 1944 · Market Garden

Winters and part of Easy moved to Uden while the rest of the battalion was still at Veghel. On 22 September the Germans cut the road between the two towns; for a day the group in Uden held the town with a handful of men, bluffing strength they did not have.

On the ground: Market town on the corridor; the highway through it is the original single road.

GPS 51.66000, 5.61900

6 Veghel and Koevering — the road cuts

HIGH 22–25 Sep 1944 · Market Garden

The 101st fought to reopen Hell's Highway at Veghel (22 Sep) and again at Koevering, where the Germans cut the road for a day on 24–25 September. Every hour the road was shut, the men at Arnhem were nearer defeat.

On the ground: Veghel's canal bridges were the German objective; the Koevering hamlet lies on the straight road south toward Sint-Oedenrode.

GPS 51.60815, 5.53253

7 The Island — Zetten / Randwijk sector

MEDIUM 2–4 Oct 1944 · The Island

After Market Garden failed at Arnhem, the 101st relieved the British on the Island — the flat polder between the Waal and the Neder-Rijn. The 506th took the western sector around Zetten, Randwijk and Heteren, facing the river dike.

On the ground: Polder country: dikes are the only high ground and the only roads. Everything else is flat, wet and observed.

GPS 51.93500, 5.71000

8 The Crossroads — Randwijkse Rijndijk, Heteren

HIGH 5 Oct 1944, dawn · The Island

Winters took a squad, then a platoon, against a much larger German force (Winters estimated two SS companies) at a road junction below the dike. A bayonet-led assault at first light and a covering line of machine guns broke the German force: about 50 killed and 11 captured for one Easy man killed (William Dukeman) and 22 wounded. Winters' last fight as company commander; he became battalion executive officer on 9 October.

On the ground: The memorial stands at the junction. Walk up onto the dike and look north toward the river — the Germans came from there.

GPS 51.95860, 5.73170

9 Operation Pegasus — the Rhine crossing

HIGH 22–23 Oct 1944, night · The Island

Easy provided the covering force on the south bank while about 138 Allied evaders from Arnhem, mostly British, were brought across the Neder-Rijn in boats by the 506th. Lt. Heyliger, now commanding Easy, led the crossing party.

On the ground: Look across the river toward Renkum: the escapers gathered in the woods on the far bank and signalled with a V-for-victory light.

GPS 51.95573, 5.70521

10 The dike — Heyliger shot by a sentry

LOW 31 Oct 1944 · The Island

Walking the line at night with Winters, Moose Heyliger was shot by a nervous Easy sentry and badly wounded. Norman Dike took command — the beginning of the leadership problem that would surface at Bastogne.

On the ground: Area only; the incident happened on the dike road in the Randwijk sector.

GPS 51.95800, 5.72000

11 The Island line — patrols, shelling, flood

LOW 1–25 Nov 1944 · The Island

Seven weeks of static war: outposts on the dike, night patrols across the flooded polder, German artillery, rain and cold. On 25–27 November the 101st was finally relieved and moved to France. Easy had jumped into Holland with 154 men and came out with 98.

On the ground: Area reference for the whole sector between Zetten, Randwijk and Heteren.

GPS 51.94000, 5.70000

12 Mourmelon-le-Grand — refit in Champagne

HIGH 28 Nov – 17 Dec 1944 · The Island

Old French army barracks near Reims: replacements, passes to Paris, football, and a company that expected to spend the winter here. On 17 December the German offensive in the Ardennes changed everything; the division was alerted that night.

On the ground: The camp is still a French military base; the town is the reference point.

GPS 49.14083, 4.36444

13 Bastogne — arrival by truck

HIGH 18–19 Dec 1944, night · Bastogne

Ten hours in open trucks, winter clothing grossly inadequate, short of ammunition and food. The 101st arrived at Bastogne on the night of 18–19 December, walking in past retreating troops who handed over what they could spare. The 506th moved out to the north-east at once.

On the ground: The town square and the roads radiating from it explain why Bastogne mattered: seven roads meet here.

GPS 50.00400, 5.71500

14 Bois Jacques — the front line facing Foy

HIGH 19 Dec 1944 – 2 Jan 1945 · Bastogne

Easy dug in on the edge of the Bois Jacques looking down on Foy. Encircled from 21 December, without winter gear or enough ammunition, the company held its line through fog, snow and shelling. The skies cleared on 23 December; Patton's 4th Armored Division broke through on the 26th. Harry Welsh was wounded on Christmas Eve.

On the ground: The foxholes are still there, either side of the Bizory–Foy road. Stand in one and look at Foy: that was the view for three weeks.

GPS 50.03350, 5.76040

15 Bois Jacques — the shelling of 3 January

HIGH 3 Jan 1945 · Bastogne

After a morning attack into the woods across the road, Easy was caught by German artillery in the trees: Joe Toye and Bill Guarnere each lost a leg, Buck Compton was evacuated — officially for severe trench foot; the ‘breakdown’ of the book and the series is Ambrose's interpretation, which Compton himself rejected. Tree bursts made the wood itself the weapon.

On the ground: Same ground as the foxholes; the memorial beside the road lists the fourteen Easy men killed around Bastogne.

GPS 50.03000, 5.76200

16 Bois Jacques — 9–10 January

MEDIUM 9–10 Jan 1945 · Bastogne

Renewed attacks into the woods toward Foy and Noville; on 10 January a barrage killed Skip Muck and Alex Penkala in their foxhole. The company was now down to about half its Holland strength.

On the ground: Wood-line west of the foxhole site; approximate.

GPS 50.03200, 5.75200

17 Foy — the attack of 13 January

HIGH 13 Jan 1945 · Bastogne

Easy attacked across the open snow into Foy. Lt. Dike's advance stopped in the open — Winters and Lipton described him as freezing; Clancy Lyall said he saw Dike wounded in the shoulder — and Winters, watching from the wood-line, sent Ronald Speirs to relieve him. Speirs ran through the village to link up with I Company and back again. Foy fell; Easy lost one man killed and several wounded — Shifty Powers shot the German sniper who had done much of the damage.

On the ground: Walk from the wood-line down to the village: about 250 m of open ground with no cover. That is what the company crossed.

GPS 50.04469, 5.74920

18 Noville

HIGH 14–15 Jan 1945 · Bastogne

The 506th pushed north from Foy to Noville, the village the 10th Armored's Team Desobry had held on 19–20 December. Easy took it on 15 January, the day the US 1st and 3rd Armies were about to meet at Houffalize and close the Bulge.

On the ground: The church and the crossroads are the same; the village was rebuilt after the war.

GPS 50.06150, 5.75730

Read more: Wikipedia: Siege of Bastogne

19 Rachamps — the last Bastogne attack

HIGH 16 Jan 1945 · Bastogne

Easy's final objective in the Ardennes. The company spent the night in the church, where the village schoolgirls sang for them; the Easy Company memorial is beside it. On 17 January the 101st was relieved. Bastogne had cost Easy fourteen killed, about 32 wounded and 21 evacuated for cold-weather injuries.

On the ground: The church appears in the series; Guarnere and Heffron planted a tree here at the unveiling.

GPS 50.08380, 5.78710

20 Alsace — the Moder line

LOW 20 Jan – 4 Feb 1945 · Alsace

In late January the 101st moved to Alsace as Operation Nordwind, the last German offensive in the west, was ending. The 506th took over the line at Pfaffenhoffen and Niedermodern on the Moder, west of Haguenau, in deep snow, patrolling and being shelled; Easy's 2nd Battalion stayed in reserve at Grassendorf until the regiment moved into Haguenau on 5 February.

On the ground: Area reference: the villages between Pfaffenhoffen and Haguenau along the river.

GPS 48.84200, 7.60600

21 Haguenau — the Moder river patrol

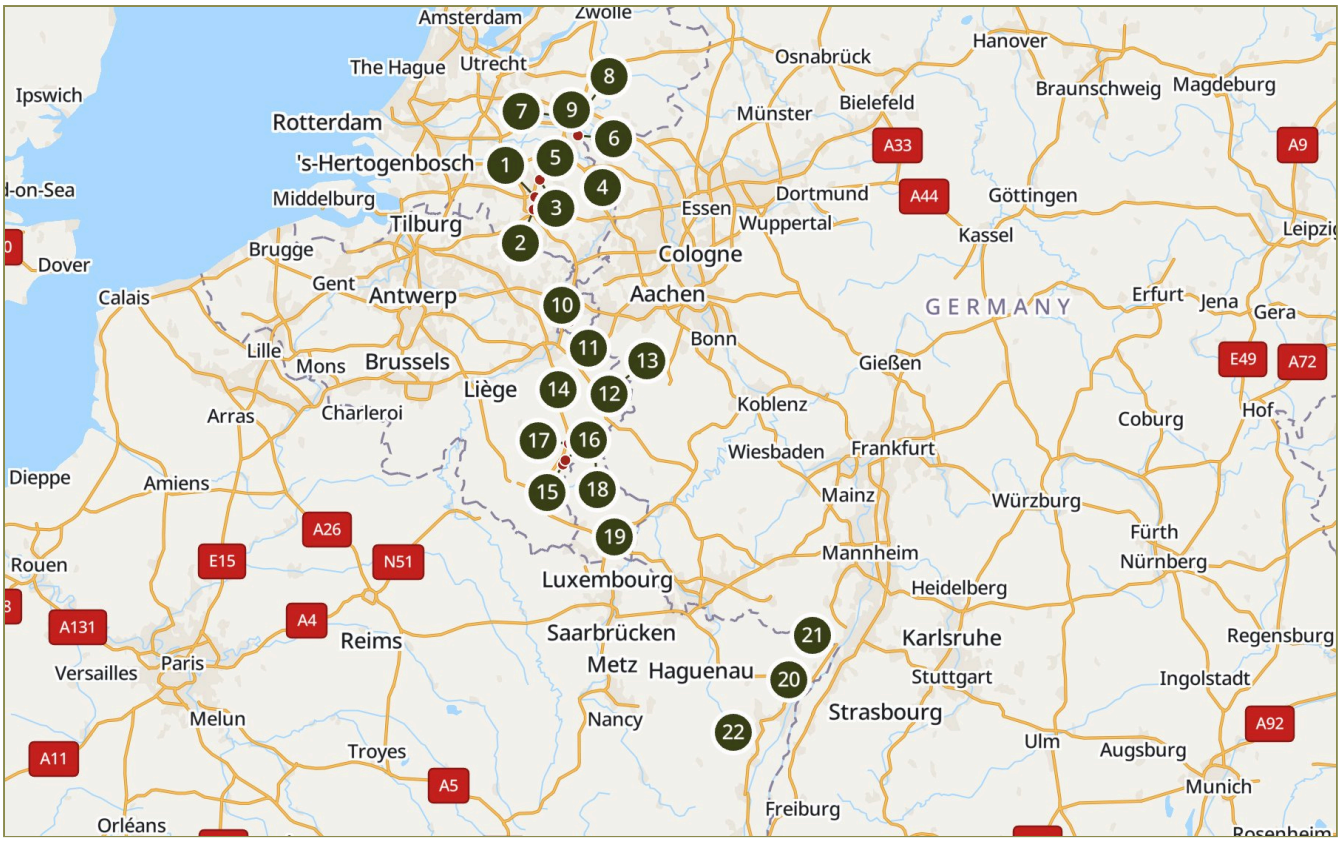
HIGH 5–23 Feb 1945 · Alsace

Easy held the south bank of the Moder inside Haguenau, the Germans a street away on the north bank. On the night of 15 February a patrol led by Lt. Jones crossed the river, blew into a German outpost and brought back two prisoners; Eugene Jackson was mortally wounded when his own grenade detonated in the fight at the outpost; accounts differ on whether enemy fire made him drop it or it went off early. Winters quietly cancelled the second patrol ordered for the next night. Relieved on 23 February; back to Mourmelon by rail on the 25th — the company's last combat.

On the ground: The river is startlingly narrow. The Liberation memorial on the Moder canal marks the axis the Americans finally crossed on 16 March, after Easy had gone.

GPS 48.82000, 7.79200

MARKET GARDEN, THE BULGE AND NORDWIND — THE WIDER WAR



1. Son bridge & 101st memorial
2. Eindhoven — 18 Septemberplein
3. Veghel — canal bridges
4. Overloon War Museum
5. Grave bridge (John S. Thompson bridge)
6. Nijmegen — Waal crossing & road bridge
7. Crossroads memorial, Heteren
8. John Frost Bridge, Arnhem
9. Airborne Museum Hartenstein, Oosterbeek
10. Netherlands American Cemetery, Margraten
11. Henri-Chapelle American Cemetery
12. Baugnez crossroads — Malmedy massacre memorial
13. Elsenborn Ridge
14. December 44 Museum, La Gleize
15. Bastogne War Museum & Mardasson Memorial
16. Easy Company foxholes, Bois Jacques
17. Houffalize — the Panther
18. Clervaux — castle & museum
19. Luxembourg American Cemetery — Patton's grave
20. Haguenau — the Moder river front
21. Fort de Schoenenbourg — Maginot Line
22. Natzweiler-Struthof

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

THE DECISIVE FACTORS

The plan — Market Garden. Montgomery's bid to end the war in 1944: three airborne divisions (US 101st, US 82nd, British 1st) would seize the bridges along one road from Eindhoven to Arnhem, and XXX Corps' tanks would drive 100 km up it in two days to cross the Rhine. The 101st — Easy's division — held the southern 25 km: Son, Eindhoven, Sint-Oedenrode, Veghel. 17 Sep 1944 · 35,000 airborne troops · one two-lane road · objective: across the Rhine in 48 hours

Why it failed. Two SS panzer divisions were refitting near Arnhem; the British landed 13 km from their bridge; the Son bridge was blown, costing a day; Nijmegen's bridge took three; radios failed. Frost's 700 men held Arnhem bridge for four days and were overrun on 21 September; the rest of 1st Airborne was evacuated across the Rhine on the night of 25–26 September. Of 10,000 men, 2,400 came back. XXX Corps reached Nijmegen on day 4, Arnhem never

Hell's Highway. The corridor road was cut by German counterattacks at Son (19 Sep), Veghel (22 Sep) and Koevering (24–25 Sep). Every cut stopped the whole army; the 101st spent the operation running up and down its 25 km to reopen it. Easy's Nuenen ambush and the Uden stand were both part of this. 101st casualties in Holland ≈ 3,800 (official history: 2,110 in the airborne phase + 1,682 on the Island) · Easy: 154 men in, 98 out (company accounts)

The Island. When Arnhem was lost, the front froze on the polder between the Waal and the Neder-Rijn. The 101st held it for seven weeks of dike outposts, night patrols, artillery and flooding — the war Easy fought at the Crossroads and at Operation

Pegasus. The Netherlands north of the rivers stayed occupied until May 1945 and starved through the Hunger Winter. 2 Oct – 27 Nov 1944

The German surprise — 16 December 1944. Three German armies, 200,000 men and 600 tanks, attacked through the Ardennes in fog that grounded Allied aircraft, aiming for Antwerp. The 101st, refitting at Mourmelon with half its officers on leave, was, with the 82nd, half of SHAEF's continental reserve — XVIII Airborne Corps. The 82nd moved first, to the northern shoulder; the 101st went to Bastogne, on the road within 24 hours. 5:30 am, 16 Dec · 1,600 guns · weather closed until 23 Dec

Bastogne — the road hub. Seven roads meet at Bastogne; whoever held it controlled movement through the southern Ardennes. The 101st arrived on the night of 18–19 December, was surrounded by the 21st, and answered the surrender demand on the 22nd with McAuliffe's 'Nuts!'. Clear skies on the 23rd brought supply drops; Patton's 4th Armored broke through on the 26th. The fighting to push the Germans back from Foy and Noville went on into mid-January. Encircled 21–26 Dec · temperatures at times around −20 °C or lower · 101st casualties ≈ 3,000 · Easy: 14 killed · ≈32 wounded · 21 cold-weather evacuations

Winter warfare. Grossly inadequate winter clothing, few overshoes, little ammunition, shelling by tree burst in the woods. In Easy Company during the siege, frostbite and trench foot evacuations rivalled the wounded; the 101st went into Bastogne with its artillery still short of shells — by 22 December ammunition was severely rationed — and with rations for a day. The relief columns brought the first proper supplies on 27 December. Snow from 22 Dec · frostbite evacuations rivalled wounds

Operation Nordwind — Alsace. On 1 January 1945 the Germans launched their last western offensive, in Alsace, to exploit the Bulge. The 101st was sent from the Ardennes straight to the Moder valley to shore up the Seventh Army. Haguenau, liberated in December, had been retaken by the Germans on 25 January; Easy held the river line through the town in February. 1 Jan – 25 Jan 1945 · Haguenau finally liberated 16 Mar 1945

The end of Easy's combat. The Moder patrol of 15 February was the company's last action. On 25 February the 506th went back to Mourmelon by rail; on 15 March Eisenhower presented the 101st with the first Presidential Unit Citation ever given to a whole division, for Bastogne. The next campaign — the Rhine, Bavaria, Berchtesgaden — was occupation, not battle. Sep 1944 – Feb 1945: Easy's principal combat period · ≈45 killed in Holland and Belgium

KEY CAMPAIGN SITES

1 Son bridge & 101st memorial

HIGH Market Garden · 101st

The blown bridge that cost the corridor its first day.

What you can see: Memorial on 17 Septemberplein.

GPS 51.51200, 5.49120

2 Eindhoven — 18 Septemberplein

HIGH Market Garden · 101st

The first Dutch city liberated by the airborne corridor.

What you can see: City centre square.

GPS 51.44250, 5.47750

3 Veghel — canal bridges

HIGH Market Garden · Hell's Highway

The corridor's most-attacked point.

What you can see: Bridges over the Zuid-Willemsvaart.

GPS 51.60815, 5.53253

4 Overloon War Museum

HIGH Market Garden aftermath

Site of the October 1944 tank battle east of the corridor; one of the largest vehicle collections in Europe.

What you can see: Two hours; big halls.

GPS 51.56996, 5.95694

5 Grave bridge (John S. Thompson bridge)

HIGH Market Garden · 82nd

Taken intact in minutes on 17 September.

What you can see: Bridge over the Maas.

GPS 51.76925, 5.73665

6 Nijmegen — Waal crossing & road bridge

HIGH Market Garden · 82nd

The canvas-boat assault of 20 September.

What you can see: South-bank memorial and the bridge.

GPS 51.85110, 5.87170

7 Crossroads memorial, Heteren

HIGH The Island · Easy Company

Winters' fight of 5 October.

What you can see: Dike road junction.

GPS 51.95861, 5.73173

8 John Frost Bridge, Arnhem

HIGH Market Garden · British 1st Airborne

The bridge too far.

What you can see: North end of the bridge.

GPS 51.97750, 5.91150

9 Airborne Museum Hartenstein, Oosterbeek

HIGH Market Garden · British 1st Airborne

The Arnhem battle from Urquhart's HQ.

What you can see: Museum.

GPS 51.98775, 5.83267

10 Netherlands American Cemetery, Margraten

HIGH Cemetery · 8,300 graves

American dead of Holland, the Bulge and the Rhineland, including 101st men.

What you can see: Between the Dutch and Belgian legs of the tour.

GPS 50.81775, 5.80338

11 Henri-Chapelle American Cemetery

HIGH Cemetery · 7,900 graves

Bulge and Rhineland dead, north of Liège.

What you can see: On the way to the northern shoulder.

GPS 50.69661, 5.89908

12 Baugnez crossroads — Malmedy massacre memorial

HIGH The Bulge · northern shoulder

84 American prisoners shot on 17 December.

What you can see: Memorial at the crossroads; the Baugnez 44 museum closed in 2023.

GPS 50.40369, 6.06674

13 Elsenborn Ridge

HIGH The Bulge · northern shoulder

Where the 2nd and 99th Divisions stopped the 6th Panzer Army — the shoulder that held.

What you can see: Open ridge; memorials at Rocherath-Krinkelt.

GPS 50.46300, 6.23000

14 December 44 Museum, La Gleize

HIGH The Bulge · Kampfgruppe Peiper

Peiper's furthest point; King Tiger.

What you can see: Museum.

GPS 50.41006, 5.84559

15 Bastogne War Museum & Mardasson Memorial

HIGH The Bulge · Bastogne

The siege in one museum; the American memorial beside it.

What you can see: Museum and memorial.

GPS 50.00850, 5.73850

16 Easy Company foxholes, Bois Jacques

HIGH The Bulge · Easy Company

The company's line facing Foy.

What you can see: Paid entry; app guide.

GPS 50.03353, 5.76039

17 Houffalize — the Panther

HIGH The Bulge · closing the pocket

Where the two US armies met on 16 January.

What you can see: Town centre tank.

GPS 50.12894, 5.79070

18 Clervaux — castle & museum

HIGH The Bulge · Luxembourg

The castle held for two days by the 110th Infantry on 16–18 December, delaying Panzer Lehr on the road to Bastogne.

What you can see: Museum in the castle.

GPS 50.05450, 6.02700

19 Luxembourg American Cemetery — Patton's grave

HIGH Cemetery · 5,000 graves

The Third Army's dead of the Bulge and their general.

What you can see: Hamm, outside Luxembourg city.

GPS 49.61150, 6.18550

20 Haguenau — the Moder river front

HIGH Nordwind · Easy Company

Easy's last line.

What you can see: South bank inside the town.

GPS 48.82000, 7.79200

21 Fort de Schoenenbourg — Maginot Line

HIGH Alsace · fortress

The fortified frontier the 1945 winter battles sat on.

What you can see: Guided/self-guided.

GPS 48.96800, 7.91400

22 Natzweiler-Struthof

HIGH Alsace · concentration camp

The only Nazi camp on French soil; liberated November 1944.

What you can see: Memorial site in the Vosges.

GPS 48.45480, 7.25250

MUSEUMS



1 Wings of Liberation Museum
2 Freedom Museum
3 Airborne Museum Hartenstein
4 Airborne at the Bridge
5 Bastogne War Museum
6 Bois Jacques foxholes
7 101st Airborne Museum — Le Mess
8 Bastogne Barracks
9 December 44 Museum
10 Baugnez crossroads memorial
11 Musée Historique de Haguenau
12 Fort de Schoenenbourg
13 Overloon War Museum
14 Netherlands American Cemetery
15 Luxembourg American Cemetery
16 Natzweiler-Struthof

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors

The museums worth your time on this part of the route. Check opening days before you travel.

1 Wings of Liberation Museum

Best · Day 1 · 1.5–2 hr

Brabant liberation and Market Garden, beside the 101st landing zone.

GPS 51.51595, 5.44020

2 Freedom Museum

Groesbeek · Day 2 · 1.5 hr

Market Garden and the Rhineland; the 82nd's landing ground.

GPS 51.78565, 5.93701

3 Airborne Museum Hartenstein

Oosterbeek · Day 2 · 1.5 hr

The Arnhem battle in Urquhart's HQ hotel.

GPS 51.98775, 5.83267

4 Airborne at the Bridge

Arnhem · Day 2 · 30 min

Small museum at the north end of the John Frost Bridge.

GPS 51.97800, 5.90900

5 Bastogne War Museum

Bastogne (Mardasson) · Day 3 · 2 hr

The best single Bulge museum; beside the Mardasson memorial.

GPS 50.00850, 5.73850

6 Bois Jacques foxholes

Foy · Day 3 · 45 min

Easy Company's preserved positions; app-guided walk.

GPS 50.03353, 5.76039

7 101st Airborne Museum — Le Mess

Bastogne · Day 4 · 1–1.5 hr

Uniforms, artefacts, bomb-shelter experience.

GPS 49.99925, 5.71221

8 Bastogne Barracks

Bastogne · Day 4 · 1.5 hr

McAuliffe's 'Nuts' HQ cellar; vehicle hall. Guided.

GPS 50.01058, 5.71614

9 December 44 Museum

La Gleize · Day 4 · 1–1.5 hr

Peiper's high-water mark; King Tiger.

GPS 50.41006, 5.84559

10 Baugnez crossroads memorial

Malmedy · Day 4 · 30 min

The Malmedy massacre memorial. The Baugnez 44 museum closed permanently in January 2023 — memorial only.

GPS 50.40369, 6.06674

11 Musée Historique de Haguenau

Haguenau · Day 5 · 45 min

The town's history including the two liberations of 1944–45.

GPS 48.81289, 7.79188

12 Fort de Schoenenbourg

Hunspach · Day 5 · 2 hr

Maginot Line fortress; galleries and turrets.

GPS 48.96800, 7.91400

13 Overloon War Museum

Overloon · Extra · 2 hr

Large vehicle collection on the site of the October 1944 tank battle east of the corridor.

GPS 51.56996, 5.95694

14 Netherlands American Cemetery

Margraten · Extra · 1 hr

8,300 American graves, including men of the 101st from Holland.

GPS 50.81775, 5.80338

15 Luxembourg American Cemetery

Hamm, Luxembourg · Extra · 1 hr

5,000 Bulge dead and General Patton's grave.

GPS 49.61150, 6.18550

16 Natzweiler-Struthof

Natzwiller, Alsace · Extra · 2 hr

The only Nazi concentration camp on French soil, in the Vosges south-west of Haguenau.

GPS 48.45480, 7.25250

PEOPLE

THE COMPANY'S WAR IN BRIEF

Easy Company was one of the first American rifle companies built entirely from paratrooper volunteers. It fought from the night drop into Normandy to the end of the war in the Alps, and it lost 48 men killed along the way (the Winters/Ambrose count; other rosters give 49).

Toccoa, 1942–43. Company E of the 506th Parachute Infantry was formed at Camp Toccoa, Georgia, in summer 1942 under 1st Lt. Herbert Sobel, who was soon promoted captain. Most of its men came straight from civilian life. They ran Currahee Mountain — "three miles up, three miles down" — until only the toughest were left, then trained at Benning, Mackall and Bragg before sailing for England in September 1943.

England, 1943–44. The company trained at Aldbourne, Wiltshire. Sobel's clash with his platoon leader Richard Winters led almost every sergeant to hand in his stripes. Sobel was moved out and 1st Lt. Thomas Meehan took command.

Normandy, June–July 1944. Easy jumped behind Utah Beach on the night of 5–6 June. Meehan's plane was shot down and everyone aboard was killed, so Winters took command. That morning he led about a dozen men against the guns at Brécourt Manor. Easy then fought at Carentan and Bloody Gulch and sailed back to England in July.

Holland, September–November 1944. Easy jumped into Holland on 17 September for Market Garden. It entered Eindhoven, was thrown back at Nuenen, and spent weeks on "the Island" between the rivers. On 5 October Winters led the crossroads attack and was then promoted to battalion executive officer. The company helped rescue about 138 Allied soldiers, mostly British airborne troops, in Operation Pegasus.

Bastogne, December 1944–January 1945. Rushed to the Ardennes with too little winter clothing and ammunition, Easy held the edge of the Bois Jacques above Foy. Shelling cost the company Toye's and Guarnere's legs and the lives of Muck and Penkala. On 13 January Lt. Ronald Speirs took over in the middle of the attack on Foy, and the company went on to Noville and Rachamps.

Haguenau and Germany, 1945. Easy held the Moder river in Alsace in February 1945. It then watched the Ruhr pocket from the Rhine and moved into Bavaria, where on 28–29 April it entered a Kaufering sub-camp near Landsberg (probably Kaufering IV). On 5 May it reached Berchtesgaden and the Obersalzberg.

Austria and home, 1945. After Germany surrendered, Easy occupied Zell am See and Kaprun in Austria. It moved to France in the summer to train for Japan, but the war ended first. The 101st Airborne was inactivated on 30 November 1945.

THE OFFICERS

Richard D. Winters "Dick" — Platoon leader, company commander, then battalion commander. Born 21 Jan 1918, New Holland, Pennsylvania · died 2 Jan 2011, Campbelltown, Pennsylvania

An economics graduate of Franklin & Marshall College, Winters joined Easy at Toccoa in 1942 as a platoon leader. When Lt. Meehan was killed on D-Day he took command, and that morning led about a dozen men against the four guns at Brécourt Manor. He was recommended for the Medal of Honor and received the Distinguished Service Cross. He was wounded at Carentan and led the crossroads attack in Holland on 5 October 1944, then became battalion executive officer and later its commander, ending the war as a major. Calm, sober and devout, he was the man Easy trusted most.

Decorations: Distinguished Service Cross — leading the attack on the guns at Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944 (he had been recommended for the Medal of Honor); Bronze Star — reason not recorded (some records show a second); Purple Heart — wounded in the leg at Carentan, June 1944.

After the war: Worked for the Nixon family firm, then ran his own animal-feed business in Hershey. Wrote a memoir with Col. Cole Kingseed (2006).

Lewis Nixon III “Nix” — Battalion intelligence officer, Winters' closest friend. Born 30 Sep 1918, New York City · died 11 Jan 1995, Los Angeles

The wealthy, Yale-educated son of an industrial family, Nixon was never in Easy itself but served on 2nd Battalion staff beside it from Toccoa onward. He jumped into Normandy and Holland, where a bullet grazed his forehead. In March 1945 he jumped with the 17th Airborne in Operation Varsity; his plane was hit and only four men got out. He drank heavily during the war, and Winters stood by him throughout.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded (some sources say two); Parachute wings with three combat-jump stars — Normandy, Holland and Operation Varsity, a rare set.

After the war: Brought Winters into the family business; later remarried and gave up drinking.

Herbert M. Sobel — Easy's first commander. Born 26 Jan 1912, Chicago · died 30 Sep 1987, Waukegan, Illinois

Sobel built Easy at Toccoa and drove it relentlessly: extra runs, harsh punishments, cancelled passes. His men found him petty and doubted his judgement in the field. When he court-martialled Winters in England, nearly every sergeant offered to give up his stripes, and he was moved out in early 1944. He went on to run a parachute school and later served as the regiment's supply officer, and he jumped on D-Day. Several veterans later credited him with making Easy as tough as it was.

Decorations: Bronze Star — no citation survives; one account links it to D-Day, when he and four men knocked out a German machine-gun nest with grenades.

After the war: Worked in Chicago as a credit manager; spent his last years in a veterans' home.

Thomas Meehan III — Company commander, Feb–June 1944. Born 8 Jul 1921, Philadelphia · killed in action 6 Jun 1944, near Beuzeville-au-Plain, Normandy

A Philadelphia art student who transferred to Easy from B Company, Meehan took command after Sobel left. On D-Day he led the company headquarters in C-47 "Chalk 66". The plane was hit by flak and crashed near Beuzeville-au-Plain; everyone aboard was killed, including 1st Sgt. William Evans. Easy did not learn his fate until long after. The wreck was found in the early 1950s and reportedly excavated in 1989; a memorial now marks the site.

Ronald C. Speirs “Sparky” — Easy's longest-serving commander, Jan 1945 to the end. Born 20 Apr 1920, Edinburgh, Scotland · died 11 Apr 2007, Montana

Brought up in Boston, Speirs fought in Normandy with D Company, including at Brécourt, and was wounded. He won the Silver Star in Holland for a solo patrol across the Lower Rhine. On 13 January 1945, in the attack on Foy, Winters sent him to take over Easy mid-battle; he famously ran through the German-held village to reach I Company and back. He led Easy through Haguenau, Germany and Austria. Stories that he shot prisoners were never confirmed.

Decorations: Silver Star — swam the Lower Rhine (Neder Rijn) alone near Randwijk to scout German positions and came back with a captured boat, 10 October 1944, wounded on the way back; Bronze Star — reason not recorded (number not confirmed); Purple Heart with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — wounded in Normandy, June 1944, and in Holland, 10 October 1944; Legion of Merit — after the war, for service from October 1961 to March 1964, a period that included Laos.

After the war: Stayed in the Army — Korea, US governor of Spandau Prison in Berlin, Laos; retired a lieutenant colonel.

Lynn Compton “Buck” — Platoon leader. Born 31 Dec 1921, Los Angeles · died 25 Feb 2012, Burlington, Washington

A UCLA catcher and Rose Bowl footballer, Compton won the Silver Star at Brécourt Manor. He was shot through the buttocks in Holland and came back to lead his platoon at Bastogne. After watching his friends Toye and Guarnere lose their legs in January 1945, he was evacuated with severe trench foot.

Decorations: Silver Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944; Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — shot through the buttocks in Holland, September 1944.

After the war: Police detective, then prosecutor who led the case against Robert Kennedy's assassin, Sirhan Sirhan (1969); California appeals court judge 1970–90.

Harry F. Welsh “Welshy” — Platoon leader, later executive officer. Born 27 Sep 1918, Pennsylvania · died 21 Jan 1995, Wilkes-Barre, Pennsylvania

A former enlisted paratrooper who reportedly won and lost his sergeant's stripes several times for fighting, Welsh went to officer school and joined Easy. He led 1st Platoon into Carentan and was wounded at Bastogne at Christmas 1944, returning in 1945. He was Winters' closest friend in the company.

Decorations: Bronze Star with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — reasons not recorded; Purple Heart with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — one for the mortar wound at Bastogne, Christmas 1944; the other wound is not recorded.

After the war: Married Kitty Grogan, a friend of Winters, in a wedding dress made from parachute silk; taught at GAR and Coughlin high schools in Wilkes-Barre, then was Director of Pupil Services for the Wilkes-Barre Area School District until 1983.

Frederick Heyliger “Moose” — Company commander, Oct 1944. Born 23 Jun 1916, Acton, Massachusetts · died 3 Nov 2001, Concord, Massachusetts

A big, well-liked former mortar platoon leader, Heyliger took command of Easy when Winters moved up in October 1944. He led the company in Operation Pegasus, the night rescue across the Rhine of about 138 Allied soldiers, mostly British, and received the British Military Cross. On 31 October he was badly wounded by one of his own sentries while checking the line with Winters, and he did not return.

Decorations: British Military Cross — leading Operation Pegasus, the rescue of about 138 Allied evaders, mostly British, night of 22–23 October 1944; Bronze Star — citation not found; Purple Heart — shot by his own sentry on the Island, 31 October 1944.

After the war: Studied horticulture at the University of Massachusetts.

Norman S. Dike Jr. “Foxhole Norman” — Company commander, Nov 1944 – 13 Jan 1945. Born 19 May 1918, Brooklyn, New York · died 23 Jun 1989, Rolle, Switzerland

A Brown graduate and Yale law student, Dike came from regimental staff to command Easy after Heyliger. The men felt he was rarely seen on the line, hence the nickname, yet he earned two Bronze Stars, one for carrying wounded men to safety at Bastogne. During the attack on Foy on 13 January 1945 the advance stalled and Winters replaced him with Speirs. Why it stalled is disputed (see the notes at the end).

Decorations: Bronze Star — rallying scattered paratroopers to hold the road junction at Uden, Holland, while surrounded, 23–25 September 1944; Bronze Star (second award) — carrying three wounded men out of an exposed position under fire at Bastogne, 3 January 1945; Purple Heart with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — one reportedly for a shoulder wound at Foy, 13 January 1945.

After the war: Yale law degree, work in Japan and for the CIA, then a legal and business career; lived in Switzerland from 1960.

THE SERGEANTS

C. Carwood Lipton “Lip” — First sergeant, later lieutenant. Born 30 Jan 1920, Huntington, West Virginia · died 16 Dec 2001, North Carolina

His father was killed and his mother paralysed in a car crash when he was ten. Lipton enlisted in 1942 and was one of Easy's first privates. He fought at Brécourt Manor, was wounded at Carentan, and became first sergeant — the man who held the company together at Bastogne while its officers failed or fell. After Foy he was commissioned a lieutenant in the field, and he served through Germany and Austria.

Decorations: Bronze Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944, where he climbed a tree to fire into the German position (some records show a second Bronze Star); Purple Heart — shell fragments to the face and groin at Carentan, June 1944; his headstone records two more, for three in all.

After the war: Engineering degree from Marshall; a long career with the glassmaker Owens-Illinois.

William Guarnere “Wild Bill” — 2nd Platoon sergeant. Born 28 Apr 1923, South Philadelphia · died 8 Mar 2014, Philadelphia

The youngest of ten in an Italian-American family, Guarnere built Sherman tanks before enlisting. He jumped into Normandy knowing his brother had just been killed in Italy, and fought with fury at Brécourt Manor, earning the Silver Star. Shot in the leg in Holland, he slipped out of hospital to rejoin the company. On 3 January 1945 near Foy he lost a leg to shellfire while helping the wounded Joe Toye.

Decorations: Silver Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944; Bronze Star with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — reasons not recorded; Purple Heart (two) — a sniper's bullet in the leg on the Island, October 1944, and the loss of his leg near Foy, 3 January 1945.

After the war: Veterans' advocate; co-wrote Brothers in Battle, Best of Friends (2007) with Babe Heffron. Statues of him stand in Pennsylvania.

Donald G. Malarkey — Mortar sergeant. Born 31 Jul 1921, Astoria, Oregon · died 30 Sep 2017, Salem, Oregon

A University of Oregon student from the Columbia River coast, Malarkey fought at Brécourt and then in every Easy campaign. He is said to have spent more continuous time on the line than anyone in the company without being seriously wounded. The death of his close friends Skip Muck and Alex Penkala at Bastogne stayed with him all his life.

Decorations: Bronze Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944; a second Bronze Star, reason not recorded; Purple Heart — the wound is not recorded; French Legion of Honour — awarded in 2009 as a surviving veteran of the liberation of France.

After the war: County commissioner in Oregon; wrote Easy Company Soldier (2008).

Joseph Toye “Joe” — Squad leader. Born 14 Mar 1919, Hughestown, Pennsylvania · died 3 Sep 1995, Reading, Pennsylvania

A coal miner's son who left school to work in the mines, Toye was known as one of the toughest men in the company. He fought at Brécourt, was wounded in Holland and again at Bastogne, and on 3 January 1945 lost his right leg to shellfire in the Bois Jacques. He had more wounds than almost anyone in Easy.

Decorations: Bronze Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944; Purple Hearts — three or four (sources differ; a local marker calls it the most in Easy): shellfire in Holland, autumn 1944; wounds at Bastogne; and the loss of his leg near Foy, 3 January 1945.

After the war: Worked at the Grace iron mine for Bethlehem Steel. Winters gave his eulogy.

Floyd Talbert “Tab” — Squad leader, briefly first sergeant. Born 26 Aug 1923, Howard County, Indiana · died Oct 1982, Shasta Lake, California

Talbert was wounded in Normandy, reportedly by an Easy man who mistook him in the dark for a German. He came back to serve in Holland and at Bastogne and was made first sergeant, a job he later gave up to return to his men. Winters rated him among the finest soldiers in the company.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — most likely for the bayonet wound in Normandy, June 1944.

After the war: Worked in industry and farming; lost touch with Easy until a reunion in 1981.

Denver Randleman “Bull” — Squad leader. Born 20 Nov 1920, Rector, Arkansas · died 26 Jun 2003

A big, quiet Arkansan and former foundry worker, Randleman fought in Normandy and at Carentan. At Nuenen in Holland in September 1944 he was wounded and cut off; he hid in a barn, killed a German soldier who found him, and rejoined the company the next day. He went on through Bastogne, Foy and Haguenau.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — shoulder wound from a tank shell in Holland, September 1944, the fight in which he hid in the barn.

After the war: Service manager for a Caterpillar dealer, then construction superintendent in Louisiana.

Warren Muck “Skip” — Sergeant, mortar squad. Born 31 Jan 1922, Tonawanda, New York · killed in action 10 Jan 1945, Bois Jacques, near Foy, Belgium

A cheerful young man from upstate New York and Malarkey's closest friend, Muck jumped into Normandy and Holland. On 10 January 1945 a shell struck the foxhole he shared with Pvt. Alex Penkala in the Bois Jacques, killing both. Both are buried in the Luxembourg American Cemetery at Hamm.

Decorations: Bronze Star with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — reasons not recorded; Purple Heart (posthumous) — killed in the Bois Jacques, 10 January 1945.

Darrell Powers “Shifty” — Rifleman and marksman, later staff sergeant. Born 13 Mar 1923, Clinchco, Virginia · died 17 Jun 2009, Bristol, Tennessee

Raised hunting in the Appalachian hills, Powers was one of Easy's best shots. At Bastogne he noticed a "tree that wasn't there yesterday" — a hidden German position — and at Foy he killed a sniper. He was never wounded in combat, but after winning the lottery for a trip home in 1945 he was badly hurt when his truck crashed on the way.

Decorations: Bronze Star with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — reasons not recorded.

After the war: Machinist, then more than 20 years with Clinchfield Coal; married to Dorothy for about 60 years.

THE MEN

Edward Heffron “Babe” — Machine gunner. Born 16 May 1923, South Philadelphia · died 1 Dec 2013, Stratford, New Jersey

A shipyard worker from an Irish Catholic family, Heffron joined Easy as a replacement in England after Normandy. He jumped into Holland and fought at Bastogne, where in late December 1944 he was pinned down trying to reach his dying friend John Julian. He was at a Kaufering sub-camp and in Berchtesgaden in 1945. He and Bill Guarnere, from the same neighbourhood, stayed best friends for life.

Decorations: Bronze Star — Bastogne, winter 1944–45 (the action is not recorded); Purple Heart — the wound is not recorded.

After the war: Worked at a whiskey distillery and then on the Philadelphia docks; co-wrote Brothers in Battle, Best of Friends (2007).

George Luz — Company radio operator. Born 17 Jun 1921, Fall River, Massachusetts · died 15 Oct 1998, West Warwick, Rhode Island

The company's joker, famous for his impressions of officers, Luz carried Easy's radio from Normandy through Holland, Bastogne and into Germany and Austria. His humour kept men going in the worst moments of the siege.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — the wound is not recorded.

After the war: Maintenance work in Rhode Island; killed in an industrial accident. About 1,600 people came to his funeral.

David Kenyon Webster — Rifleman and writer. Born 2 Jun 1922, New York City · lost at sea 9 Sep 1961, off Santa Monica, California

A Harvard English student who volunteered for the paratroopers, Webster jumped on D-Day with battalion headquarters and joined Easy afterwards. He was shot in the leg on the Island in Holland on 5 October 1944 and rejoined at Haguenau. His clear, often critical writing about the war made him the company's chronicler, and Ambrose drew heavily on it.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — a shell-fragment wound in Normandy, June 1944, and a machine-gun bullet through the leg on the Island, October 1944.

After the war: Journalist. He vanished while sailing alone off Santa Monica in 1961; his memoir Parachute Infantry was published in 1994.

Eugene Roe “Doc” — Medic. Born 17 Oct 1921 or 1922, Bayou Chêne, Louisiana · died 30 Dec 1998, Baton Rouge, Louisiana

A Cajun from St. Martin Parish, Roe was the battalion medic attached to Easy from Normandy to the end of the war. At Bastogne he worked in the snow and cold with almost no supplies, going from foxhole to foxhole under shellfire. His officer recommended him for the Silver Star, which he never received.

Decorations: Bronze Star with oak leaf cluster (two awards) — reasons not recorded; Combat Medical Badge.

After the war: Construction contractor in Louisiana.

Joseph Liebgott — Rifleman and German interpreter. Born 17 May 1915, Michigan · died 28 Jun 1992, San Bernardino, California

The son of German-speaking immigrants, Liebgott grew up in the San Francisco Bay Area and worked as a barber. He fought at Brécourt and Carentan, was wounded twice on the Island in Holland, and fought at Bastogne. In 1945 his German made him Easy's interpreter, including at a Kaufering sub-camp. Many of his comrades assumed he was Jewish; his family says he was not.

Decorations: Bronze Star — Brécourt Manor, 6 June 1944.

After the war: Barber in the Bay Area; father of eight.

Albert Blithe — Rifleman. Born 25 Jun 1923, Philadelphia · died 17 Dec 1967, Wiesbaden, West Germany

Blithe jumped into Normandy and, around Carentan, suffered a brief stress-induced blindness. He was then shot by a sniper in the collarbone and shoulder — his Purple Heart is dated 25 June 1944, his 21st birthday — and did not return to Easy. Early accounts said he died of his wounds in 1948; that is wrong.

Decorations: Purple Heart — sniper's bullet in the shoulder near Carentan, 25 June 1944.

After the war: Stayed in the Army; served in Korea with the 187th Airborne, earning a Silver Star, and died on active duty as a master sergeant. Buried at Arlington.

Edward D. Shames — Platoon leader. Born 13 Jun 1922, Norfolk, Virginia · died 3 Dec 2021, Virginia

The son of Jewish immigrants, Shames joined as an I Company paratrooper, became a 3rd Battalion operations sergeant, and received a battlefield commission in Normandy on his 22nd birthday. He joined Easy as a platoon leader, volunteered for the Pegasus rescue, and fought at Bastogne and Foy, where he helped knock out a German tank with a bazooka. At Berchtesgaden in May 1945 he took cognac labelled for Hitler's own use.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — a leg wound (sources give one to three awards).

After the war: Middle East specialist at the National Security Agency; he used the cognac for his son's Bar Mitzvah. He was the last surviving Easy officer.

Walter Gordon "Smokey" — Machine gunner. Born 15 Apr 1920 or 1921, Jackson, Mississippi · died 19 Apr 1997, Mississippi

A college student turned down by the Marines and Navy, Gordon was with Easy from Toccoa. He jumped into Normandy and Holland. On Christmas Eve 1944 at Bastogne a sniper's bullet passed through both shoulders and grazed his spine, paralysing him for a time; he never returned to combat.

Decorations: Bronze Star — reason not recorded; Purple Heart — for his wounds at Carentan (13 June 1944) and Bastogne (24 December 1944); records show one award.

After the war: Law degree, then a career as an oil and gas lease broker in Louisiana; organised Easy Company reunions from 1946.

ABOUT THE DECORATIONS

The most decorated single action was Brécourt Manor on D-Day: Winters received the Distinguished Service Cross; Compton, Guarnere and Lt. Lorraine the Silver Star; and Lipton, Malarkey, Toye, Liebgott and several others the Bronze Star.

"Reason not recorded" means no citation survives online. After the war, in 1947, the Army gave a Bronze Star to every soldier who had earned the Combat Infantryman Badge (or the Combat Medical Badge, for medics). That is the likely reason for many of these Bronze Stars, but it is not confirmed for any one man.

Every man here also shared the unit awards, so they are not repeated on each card: the Presidential Unit Citation for Normandy and again for Bastogne, the Dutch Orange Lanyard for Holland, the Belgian Fourragère, and the French Croix de Guerre with palm for Normandy.

Oak leaf cluster = a second (or further) award of the same medal.

WHERE THE SOURCES DISAGREE

These bios follow the best-supported version.

Dike
: Winters, Lipton and most witnesses say he froze at Foy; Clancy Lyall later said he had been hit in the shoulder. This guide says only that the advance stalled.

Speirs
: Stories that he shot German prisoners in Normandy; no eyewitness confirms them.

Sobel
: Remembered as a petty tyrant, but several veterans credit him with making Easy tough; the TV drama leaves out his D-Day jump.

Blithe

Early books and the TV drama said he died of his wounds in 1948 — he died in 1967; the wound was the collarbone/shoulder, not the neck.

Liebgott
Often shown as Jewish; his family says he was not.

Compton
The TV drama showed him as shell-shocked; he blamed trench foot and exhaustion.

Powers
The first edition of Ambrose said he refused a patrol at Bastogne; both he and Shames denied it and it was removed.

Shames
Whether he was among the first into the Eagle's Nest, and whether the cognac came from there or from Hitler's quarters below.

Talbert
Ambrose describes a troubled post-war life; his family disputes it.

Gordon
His first wound: Carentan (June 1944) or near Eindhoven (Holland).

Guarnere
Born 1922 or 1923; right or left leg lost.

Welsh
Wounded Christmas Eve or Christmas Day 1944; born in Audenried or Wilkes-Barre.

Winters
Recommended for the Medal of Honor for Brécourt; received the Distinguished Service Cross instead.

WORDS TO KNOW

E Company — "Easy" Company — about 140 men of the 506th Parachute Infantry Regiment

PIR — Parachute Infantry Regiment — about 2,000 paratroopers

101st — the 101st Airborne Division, "Screaming Eagles"

CP — command post — where the officers ran the fight

DZ — drop zone — the field the paratroopers were meant to land in

Stick — the 15–18 men who jumped from one plane

C-47 — the twin-engine transport plane that carried them

XO — executive officer — the second-in-command

NCO — sergeants and corporals

Flak — anti-aircraft fire

LZ — landing zone

GIR — Glider Infantry Regiment

BAR — automatic rifle

MG — machine gun

HQ — headquarters

OP — lookout post

Fallschirmjäger — German paratroopers

CREDITS

Sources for the company’s origins:
506th Infantry Regiment (Wikipedia)
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101st Airborne Division (Wikipedia)
Robert F. Sink (Wikipedia)
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Currahee Military Museum, Toccoa
Book: Stephen E. Ambrose's 1992 history of Easy Company, chapters 1–4.

Sources: Stephen Ambrose’s history of the company; Winters’ and Webster’s memoirs; TracesOfWar, Hall of Valor, Wikipedia, Find a Grave and obituaries.

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A free DZ Charlie field guide · dzcharlie.com. The phone guide adds the battle story as audio, the weapons of the company, the chain of command and a personal diary of your tour.